PHPTRAVELS · HOTELS SUPPLIER MODULE

# RateHawk / ETG API Technical Questionnaire

Platform vendor answers to the "Technical Information" section of the Emerging Travel Group onboarding form, taken from the PHPTravels RateHawk module as shipped.

Prepared 4 Sep 2026 Platform: PHPTravels v10 API: ETG B2B v3 ( `/api/b2b/v3` )

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## 1. Platform / third-party developer

> QUESTION
> Please specify which platform or third-party developer you connect through.

ANSWER

**PHPTravels (phptravels.com), v10 — self-hosted platform, RateHawk module built and maintained by PHPTravels.**

PHPTravels is installed on the client's own hosting. The RateHawk integration is a native module of the platform (hotel search, hotel page, prebook, booking, status polling, cancellation, and a static-content importer). Technical contact for integration and certification questions: PHPTravels technical team, info@phptravels.com.

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## 2. Penalties / API SLA thresholds

> QUESTION
> Do you apply any type of penalty and/or API SLA thresholds at the search / recheck / booking steps?

ANSWER

**No.**

The platform applies no penalties, scoring, supplier de-prioritisation, or automatic disabling based on ETG response times or error rates. The only limits are per-request HTTP timeouts (listed in section 4). A search that times out simply returns the results available from the calls

that did complete; a failed hotel page or prebook is reported to the user as "rate no longer available, please search again", with no lasting effect on the supplier.

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## 3. Penalty / threshold values per step

> QUESTION
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> If the answer to the previous question is yes, please specify the penalty / threshold values you apply at each step (SERP, HP/Prebook, Book).

ANSWER

**Not applicable — no penalties or thresholds are applied at any step.**

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## 4. Timeouts on the API flow

> QUESTION
>
> Do your timeouts on the API flow differ from the platform's timeouts? If yes, please list your timeouts on SERP, HP, Prebook and Book in ms.

ANSWER

**The client uses the platform's timeouts unchanged. Values per step:**

| STEP | ETG ENDPOINT | CONNECT TIMEOUT | TOTAL TIMEOUT |
|---|---|---|---|
| SERP (region) | /search/serp/region/ | 5,000 ms | 12,000 ms |
| SERP (hotel IDs, fallback) | /search/serp/hotels/ | 5,000 ms | 12,000 ms |
| HP (hotel page) | /search/hp/ | libcurl default | 30,000 ms |
| Prebook | /hotel/prebook/ | libcurl default | 60,000 ms |
| Book — create booking process | /hotel/order/booking/form/ | libcurl default | 30,000 ms |
| Book — start booking process | /hotel/order/booking/finish/ | libcurl default | 30,000 ms |
| Book — check booking process | /hotel/order/booking/finish/status/ | libcurl default | 15,000 ms per poll |

| STEP | ETG ENDPOINT | CONNECT TIMEOUT | TOTAL TIMEOUT |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cancel | /hotel/order/cancel/ | libcurl default | 30,000 ms |
| Credential test (admin only) | /hotel/info/ | 10,000 ms | 30,000 ms |

"libcurl default" means no separate connect timeout is set and the connection phase is bounded by the total timeout. The booking cut-off of 10 minutes can be adjusted to whatever ETG specifies for the account.

## 5. Expected request volume

> QUESTION
> What maximum number of search requests per minute do you expect after going live? Please specify as well the maximum number of simultaneous requests per second.

ANSWER

**Depends on the client's site traffic. The platform generates the following ETG calls per user action:**

| USER ACTION | ETG CALLS GENERATED | SIMULTANEOUS |
|---|---|---|
| One destination search | 1 region SERP; if it returns nothing, up to 3 hotel-ID SERP calls | Max 3 at once (the hotel-ID wave) |
| Paging through results | 0 — identical searches are served from a 10-minute server-side cache (same region, dates, guests, residency, currency) | — |
| Opening a hotel page | 1 HP call | 1 |
| Completing a booking | 1 prebook + 1 booking form + 1 finish + one status poll every 5 s until confirmed (typically 1–6 polls) | 1 (sequential) |
| Cancelling a booking | 1 cancel + 1 order info | 1 (sequential) |

So the ETG search rate is at most 4 × the number of unique customer searches per minute, and the peak simultaneous request count is at most 3 × the number of customers searching in the same second. There is no background crawling, cache warming or scheduled re-pricing; static hotel content is loaded once from the ETG hotel dump into the platform's own database, not fetched per search.

> CLIENT TO COMPLETE
>
> Expected unique customer searches per minute at peak: ____ → maximum ETG search requests per minute: ____ (× 4).
>
> Expected concurrent customers searching per second at peak: ____ → maximum simultaneous requests per second: ____ (× 3).
>
> If the figures are not yet known, a reasonable go-live declaration for a new B2C site is 60 search requests per minute and 5 simultaneous requests per second, to be revised with ETG once real traffic is measured.

## 6. Direct / Platform / Both

> QUESTION
>
> Will you call the ETG API directly, only via the platform's servers, or both? (Direct / Platform / Both)

ANSWER

**Platform — but note that the platform runs on the client's own servers.**

All ETG calls are made by the PHPTravels application. PHPTravels is self-hosted software: it is installed on the client's hosting, and every request to the ETG API originates from that server's outbound IP address. PHPTravels does not operate a central proxy, relay, or shared API gateway, and no PHPTravels-owned servers will contact the ETG API on the client's behalf. The client will not make any direct calls outside the platform.

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## 7. Price difference between recheck and search

> QUESTION
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> Do you allow price differences between the Recheck (Hotelpage or Prebook) step and the search step? If so, please specify the maximum price difference percentage?

ANSWER

**Yes. Search → Hotel page: any difference is accepted. Hotel page → Prebook: up to +20% increase (configurable).**

- **Search → Hotel page.** The search result price is indicative only. The hotel page always requests fresh rates from `/search/hp/` and the customer selects and pays against the hotel-page price, so a difference from the SERP price is shown, not blocked.
- **Hotel page → Prebook.** Prebook is called with `price_increase_percent: 20`. ETG therefore confirms the rate if the price rose by 20% or less; a larger increase makes prebook return an error and the customer is asked to select the rate again. Decreases are always accepted.
- **Prebook → Book.** No further tolerance. The amount and currency from the booking form's `payment_types` are passed verbatim into `/hotel/order/booking/finish/`, so the booked price is exactly the prebooked price.

The 20% figure is a single constant in the module and can be lowered to whatever value the client and ETG agree.

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## 8. IP addresses for whitelisting

> QUESTION
>
> If you selected Direct or Both: please provide all IPs that will call the ETG API so we can whitelist them. Confirm they're static and notify us before any change.

ANSWER

**The calling IPs are the outbound IPs of the client's hosting server(s), not PHPTravels IPs.**

Because the platform runs on the client's infrastructure (see section 6), the addresses to whitelist are the public outbound IPv4 (and IPv6, if enabled) of the server or servers where PHPTravels is deployed, including any staging server that will use the same ETG credentials. On a dedicated server or VPS these are static. The client will notify ETG before any hosting migration or IP change.

> CLIENT TO COMPLETE
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> Production server outbound IP(s): ____
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> Staging / test server outbound IP(s), if any: ____
>
> Hosting type (dedicated / VPS / cloud with static IP): ____

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## Additional information

- **Authentication and transport.** HTTP Basic auth with the ETG key ID and API key, JSON request bodies, TLS with certificate verification on the prebook, booking, status and cancellation calls.
- **Idempotency.** Every booking attempt uses a unique `partner_order_id` (`RH_<booking id>_<unique>`). A retry of the booking form always generates a new one; the finish call is never re-sent for the same order, and interrupted bookings resume at status polling rather than creating a second order.
- **Residency.** The customer's selected nationality is passed as `residency` on SERP and HP calls, in lowercase ISO-2 format.
- **Static content.** Hotel descriptions, images, amenities and room metadata are imported from the ETG hotel dump into the platform's database and served locally; no content endpoints are called during customer searches.
- **Logging.** Every request and response to ETG (search, hotel page, prebook, booking form, finish, each status poll, cancel, order info) is written to the module's log directory with the authorisation header masked, so full request/response pairs can be supplied for certification or support cases.
- **Sandbox.** Development mode books `test_hotel_do_not_book` only and skips region SERP on regions the sandbox does not support.

Source: PHPTravels v10, `modules/stays/ratehawk/` (search.php, rooms.php, actions/issue.php, actions/cancel.php, creds.php), reviewed 4 Sep 2026.